<video> and *<audio>* tags. Inserting media clips using these tags is very simple, just like inserting image files using *<img>*.

Table 2 compares the outdated playback techniques with the HTML5 media playback feature.

Traditional playback techniques	HTML5 media playback feature
Web designing will be a confusing task if a media clip has to be included. Even though single-line techniques are available (<embed>, <object>, etc), finding a universal way is difficult.	Being a standard technique, HTML5 media will be universally playable.
Media players vary from website to website, which means there is no standardisation. This means there is additional work of installing each of them in the visitor's device.	The visitor has to install no additional plug-ins. All the latest (popular) Web browsers come with built-in HTML5 and media playback support. Even so, sometimes the user is asked to install some additional plug-ins. But that installation is sufficient for any website.
Some websites take a lot of time to load since the external service is used.	The time taken to load the external service can be saved since it is not required.
Most websites use proprietary media players (primarily Flash) to play media clips, which means a free software fan can't browse the Web with all its attractions.	If you use a free software Web browser and if it depends on free software media playback technology, the process is truly 'libre'. Such browsers include Mozilla Firefox and Epiphany.

Table 2: A comparison between traditional and HTML5 media playback techniques

<video> Element

<video> is one of the latest tags in HTML, defined in HTML5. This element makes it possible to include video files regardless of the browser and plug-ins. Adding video files by using this tag is simple and universally accepted (except in the case of outdated Web browsers). The syntax is something like what follows:

```
<video ATTRIBUTES>
    <source src="SOURCE1" type="TYPE1">
    <source src="SOURCE2" type="TYPE2">
    …
    ERROR MESSAGE
</video>
```

Normally, the attributes are width, height and *controls*. Buttons like *Play* and *Stop* are only visible when the *Controls* attribute is given. The syntax shows that multiple sources can be added. But that doesn't mean multiple video clips can be added. *Sources* will be different copies of the same video clip with different file formats. For example, you upload the Ogg, MP4 and WebM versions of a single video clip, so the browser can choose a supported format.

Now let us look at an example:

```
<video width="420px" height="240px" controls>
    <source src="file.ogg" type="video/ogg">
    <source src="file.webm" type="video/webm">
    <source src="file.mp4" type="video/mp4">
    Your browser doesn't support HTML5 video.
</video>
```

The code is self-explanatory and in the context of the syntax, you get everything. Now let us customise it.

Auto play and Loop

The code discussed earlier gives us an integrated media player in the Web page. But advertisements and animated banners should have no controls (play, pause, etc). They must play automatically and loop forever. We can change the *<video>* element as shown below by giving just two attributes. Also note that the *controls* attribute is removed.

```
<video width="420px" height="240px" autoplay loop>
    <source src="file.ogg" type="video/ogg">
    <source src="file.webm" type="video/webm">
    <source src="file.mp4" type="video/mp4">
    Your browser doesn't support HTML5 video.
</video>
```

External controls

We can control the playback using external buttons and JavaScript. Consider the following example:

```
<!DOCTYPE HTML>
<html>
    <head>
      <meta charser="utf-8"/>

      <script>
         function play_vid()
         {
            vid = document.getElementById("vid");
            vid.play();
         }
      </script>
    </head>

    <body>
      <video width="420px" height="240px" id="vid">
         <source src="file.ogg" type="video/ogg">
         <source src="file.webm" type="video/webm">
         <source src="file.mp4" type="video/mp4">
```